

(META), which is nearly \$1.5 trillion, and Google/Alphabet (GOOG), which is \$2.2 trillion; BITC is half of the value of Nvidia or Apple.

For the crypto-curious, there are ETFs that allow you to own these without having to worry about online wallets and 24-digit passwords. Owning a few percent (less than 5%) as a flyer gives you exposure to the space if they continue to rise, but limits your losses the next time there is a crypto winter—as there was in 2013 to 2015, 2018 to 2020, and 2022 to 2023—when coins crashed 50% or more.

One-Offs

Last, in the world of alts, there are many one-of-a-kind investments. These include everything from new restaurants, plays or movies, and hard money lending against assets. Sometimes, I see funding requests for a small strip mall or a 100-unit apartment complex. These things come up all the time.

The challenges here are twofold:⁴³³ First, you must acknowledge your lack of expertise. You know nothing about what makes a restaurant, play, apartment complex, etc. successful. This is hard enough for the professionals who spend their entire lives toiling in this field. Rank amateurs tend to be a mess of assumptions and blind spots. For these “friends and family” investments, most of you are not well-equipped to make a risk/reward evaluation. (Me neither.)⁴³⁴

The second challenge is doing the proper due diligence on any of these. It is an expensive proposition in both time and money. Do you want to hire analysts, attorneys, and accountants to look into these “opportunities?”

When I see these deals, I do a little *time-traveling*: How will I feel five years from now when this deal goes south? What did I miss? Why did this go wrong? Most of the time, I imagine my future self as recalling all of the things I didn’t know and the lack of deep research into why the one-off failed. I want to avoid the epistemic trespass discussed previously.

Hence, I almost always pass.